



Clockwise from top: At Ganga Kinare Resorts in Rishikesh, guests can enjoy sound healing, meditation, treks and yoga; The Hornbill Festival in Nagaland; Meghalaya's Cherry Blossom Festival

bookings, followed by Sikkim and Meghalaya while searches for Mizoram have almost doubled in the past year.

"The region's strength isn't just a single destination, it's the diversity. Each state has its own distinct character and we are seeing multiple micro-markets emerge," says Magow of MakeMyTrip.

WELLNESS TOURISM: MIND, BODY AND SOUL

On a 30-acre campus at Kozhikode, overlooking the Western Ghats, guests at Tulåh Clinical Wellness can undergo an MRI scan in the morning, receive personalised an Ayurvedic treatment before lunch and end the day with meditation rooted in Vedantic philosophy.

The recently opened wellness retreat represents a new phase in India's fast-growing wellness tourism sector, one that seeks to blend ancient healing traditions with modern diagnostics and longevity science. Backed by an estimated $100 million investment from Kerala-born billionaire industrialist Faizal Kottikollon, Tulåh is positioning itself at the ultra-luxury end of the market, with rates starting at about $1,200 (₹1.13 lakh) a night (plus taxes), including treatments and meals.

Wellness tourism in India is undergoing a transformation with a new generation of travellers seeking measurable health outcomes rather than simple relaxation. Fairmont Mumbai has been quick to spot the trend. The hotel, which opened in April last year, describes itself as India's first hotel-based longevity destination. At the centre of the property is Blu Xone, a wellness facility designed around science-led therapies and medically supervised recovery programmes.

It's recent Blu Xone Detox & Longevity Staycations combine therapies such as Intermittent Hypoxic Training, IV therapy, cryotherapy, hyperbaric oxygen therapy and red-light therapy. Personalised, medically supervised wellness protocols with a three-to-seven-night staycation cost between ₹2.77 lakh and ₹5.38 lakh.

With wellness tourism growing, IHCL recently acquired a 51% stake in Sparsh Infratech Private Limited, the parent company of Atmantan, the luxury wellness destination near Pune. "The world is moving towards wellness," said Puneet Chhatwal, Managing Director and CEO, IHCL, in a recent interview. "People are willing to pay more to look younger, lead healthier lives and for longevity. So, the timing is right to get into wellness."

Chhatwal believes the opportunity could become a substantial business in its own right. "As a vertical, 10 years from now, I see it valued at ₹1,000 crore plus," he said. The company plans to open another five Atmantan properties over the next five years, including in Hyderabad, expected to launch next year.

But long before wellness became a buzzword, it was Ananda In the Himalayas that helped define the category, is celebrating its 25th year. According to Mahesh Natarajan, Chief Operating Officer of IHHR Hospitality, which owns Ananda: "Thirty percent of Ananda's growth is being driven by domestic travellers, a share that has grown steadily over the last five years," says Natarajan. "This reflects both the rising affluence of Indian travellers and a deepening cultural engagement with structured, preventive wellness." The Experience Ananda package which includes room, all meals and one spa therapy daily, starts at ₹63,000 per night (plus taxes) for an individual and ₹83,000 for a couple.

At Pune-based Swastik Wellbeing Sanctuary that started operations in 2024, demand has broadened well beyond the traditional spa-going audience. "Over the last few years, the demand for wellness retreats among Indian travellers has evolved significantly from being an occasional luxury to becoming a conscious lifestyle choice," says Anushree Nyati, Director of Swastik Wellbeing Sanctuary.

Participation is rising among young professionals, entrepreneurs, families and multigenerational groups. Wellness packages starts at ₹42,000 (plus taxes) on single occupancy and for ₹60,000 (plus taxes) for double occupancy. Six Senses Fort Barwara recently launched a Lunar Healing Retreat, a monthly wellness experience inspired by the restorative energy of the moon and aligned with the natural rhythm of key lunar phases. Rates start at ₹45,500 per night.

Major luxury hotel operators are also responding to the trend by incorporating wellness into future developments. The Leela Palaces, Hotels and Resorts has opened The Leela Coorg Forest Sanctuary (₹45,000 a night), a 76-acre property in the Western Ghats that places wellbeing and nature at the centre of the guest experience.

"Wellness is increasingly shaping how people choose destinations, spend their time and define luxury," says Bhatnagar. He points to a global wellness economy now valued at more than $6.8 trillion. "The affluent wellness traveller today is increasingly focussed on outcomes rather than indulgence," says Bhatnagar. "Guests want to return home feeling better than when they arrived, and that expectation is reshaping luxury hospitality."